

LEAD BY EXAMPLE
Leaders should prioritise their own mental health, taking breaks, and openly discussing mental wellness



NORMALISE MENTAL HEALTH CONVERSATIONS
Encourage open dialogue and reduce stigma, insisting that privacy will be protected at all times



ENCOURAGE WORK-LIFE BALANCE
Discourage after-hours work and meetings, and respect days off



TRAIN MANAGERS ON CONFLICT MANAGEMENT AND MENTAL HEALTH AWARENESS
Managers must learn to recognise signs of stress or mental health issues in teams and show empathy



WORKSHOPS AND TRAINING
Host these virtually or in office on mental health topics like stress management, self-help and mindfulness



EMPLOYEE ASSISTANCE PROGRAMMES (EAPs)
Provide access to confidential counselling services in office and virtually



MANAGE WORKLOADS
Assess workloads across job roles to ensure employees are not overburdened with work



EMPLOYEE SURVEYS
Conduct these regularly to gauge stress levels, work satisfaction and areas for improvement



PROVIDE MENTAL HEALTH RESOURCES
Maintain ongoing communication on mental health through newsletters and articles that provide tips, coping strategies, and resources for self-care



SUPPORT GROUPS
Establish a network of trained colleagues for employees to reach out to and discuss challenges in a safe, supportive environment

the weekday for an employee to unwind.

Organisations must also wake up to the fact that while they were chasing bottom lines, the world around them changed. People's expectations from work, especially among Gen Z and millennials, have shifted significantly, particularly in the post-pandemic world. Work is now no longer viewed as life itself, but a part of it. Travel, family, experiences have become equally important. Unlike their parents, who had to provide for basic needs—food, home, security—today's youngsters do not necessarily want to work for a salary. "They seek a larger purpose in life, of which work is just one component," says Puneet Manuja, co-founder, YourDOST. Companies have to pivot to this new reality. "Look at the increasing number of people joining the gig economy, stand-up comedy and freelancing. They don't need the security of a paycheck from a full-time job," adds Manuja.

> **"Work for Gen Z is not about earning a salary, they seek a larger purpose. Companies have yet to pivot to this new reality"**
>
> **- PUNEET MANUJA**
> *Co-founder, YourDOST*



Employees have also begun resisting exploitative work environments and become more conscious about their mental health, as have organisations. "More companies today are aware about the importance of mental health, but it is not enough. This trend has to grow," says Neerja Birla, founder chairperson, Aditya Birla Education Trust and its mental health initiative Mpower. Companies are working to reas-